Flushing out Black Money: On 8 November 2016, while declaring demonetization, the Prime Minister said, 'For years, this country has felt that corruption, black money and terrorism are festering sores, holding us back in the race towards development… To break the grip of corruption and black money, we have decided that the 500 rupee and 1,000 rupee currency notes presently in use will no longer be legal tender… notes hoarded by anti-national and anti-social elements will become just worthless pieces of paper.'

In this speech, 'black money' was referred to a total of 18 times.

Rooting out corruption: Referring to corruption, the Prime Minister said in the same speech, 'The evil of corruption has been spread by certain sections of society for their selfish interest. They have ignored the poor and cornered benefits. Some people have misused their office for personal gain… it has been a matter of concern for all of us that corruption and black money tend to be accepted as part of life. This type of thinking has afflicted our politics, our administration, and our society like an infestation of termites. None of our public institutions is free from these termites.'

Fighting terrorism by rendering counterfeit notes useless: Explaining how demonetization would put an end to terrorism, the Prime Minister explained, 'Terrorism is a frightening threat. So many have lost their lives because of it. But have you ever thought about how these terrorists get their money? Enemies from across the border run their operations using fake currency notes. This has been going on for years. Many times, those using fake 500 and 1,000 rupee notes have been caught and many such notes have been seized.'

Expounding further on this theme, the then Attorney General, Mukul Rohatgi, explained confidently to the Supreme Court: 'Out of the total estimated money in circulation of ₹15–16 lakh crore, the government expect people to deposit ₹10–11 lakh crore in banks. The